# 1995 Toyota Tercel DX (5-speed manual)

$3,300 · 169,000 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/891216283383471/

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder











| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$3,782** | **$358** | **Good** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 4/5 · 2 recalls · 59 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $3,300.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $305.25 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $21.45 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $32.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $3,781.70 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $3,781.70 |
| Amount financed | $0.00 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $3,931.70 |

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $0.00 |
| Insurance (estimate, liability) | $70.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 30 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $158.33 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $115.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $14.29 |
| Total per month | $357.62 |

Running costs without the loan: **$358/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$8,223** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Good (4/5)**

Good for its age: the Tercel's 1.5L and manual gearbox are simple and long-lived, and it gets ~30 MPG. But it's 30 years old, so wear items (rubber, seals, suspension, clutch) and older-car safety are the trade-offs.

NHTSA data for this model year: 2 recalls · 59 owner complaints (25 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (21), Seat Belts (10), Visibility (6), Tires (3), Power Train (3), Engine And Engine Cooling (3).

**Known issues for this model**

• Age: dried rubber hoses/seals, worn suspension bushings

• Clutch wear (manual transmission)

• Basic safety equipment by modern standards; airbag complaints for this year

• Muffler delete and underglow must be made street-legal

**Check on this car before buying**

• Seller reinstalls the stock muffler before sale; smog certificate required

• Clutch: no slipping in 3rd/4th under load, smooth engagement

• A/C: does it work, and has it been converted to R-134a?

• Look for leaks under the car and check timing belt history

• Can you drive a manual comfortably for delivery stop-and-go?

## Notes

IN-TOWN CAR (~$3k, for getting to and from work in Ridgecrest; not a DoorDash pick).

$3,300 OBO, 169k mi, 5-SPEED MANUAL, white. Clean title, paid off, 3+ owners. Seller: 'just fixed up everything', ~30 MPG ('30 bucks a month for gas').

Mods: MUFFLER DELETE (illegal in CA - won't pass smog/inspection; seller still has the stock muffler, make them reinstall it), underglow lights (CA limits colors/use), aftermarket rims (stock included), CarPlay screen (OEM head unit kept).

Listed 41 weeks, seller 'not in a rush'.

A 30-year-old car: basic safety equipment by today's standards. You must be able to drive a manual.

2026-10-24: Facebook listing now marked PENDING.

2026-10-29: back to Interested as an IN-TOWN CAR. No longer shows 'Pending' on Facebook - confirm it's still available.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.